

Appian Interview Experience

About the Company:

Appian Corp (Appian) is an enterprise application platform. The company's main activities include delivering solutions for process orchestration, automation, and intelligence. Its software allows users to build task forms, process solutions, and dashboards by considering the business policies, models, and procedures and enables users to monitor and respond to instantaneous critical events. The company works majorly on low code development.

Role: Software Development Engineer

Package: 25.5 LPA

Location: Chennai

Selection Process:

1. Online Test
2. Technical Round - 1
3. HR Round - 1
4. HR Round - 2

Online Test: 1 hr

Coding Questions : 3

The test was conducted on an Glider AI platform.

Question 1: Generating the Next Unique Booking Reference Code

- You are working for an airline reservation system.
- Each booking gets a unique reference number that is a permutation of digits.
- The system must generate the **next greater ordered arrangement** each time.
- If the current code is the last possible arrangement, reset to the smallest order.

Input:

`curr = sequence of integers representing the unique booking reference`

Output:

`next = next greater ordered arrangement`

Example:

Input: 1, 2, 3 Output: 1, 3, 2

Question 2: Mall Treasure Hunt

A shopping mall is divided into a grid of rooms.

Rooms can be:

'S' = start (entrance)

'O' = open/accessible

'X' = blocked

'T' = treasure chest

Task:

Find the shortest path (minimum steps) from 'S' to any 'T'.

Example:

Input:

```
[  
['S','O','O','O','O'],  
['X','O','X','X','O'],  
['X','O','T','X','X'],  
['O','O','O','O','O']  
]
```

Output: 5

Question 3: Reorganize Queue with Multiple Team Assignment

- You are given a list of students in a queue and a mapping of project teams.
- Reorganize the queue such that:
 1. Students from the same team are grouped together.
 2. If all members are present, replace them with the **team name**.
 3. Students not in any team remain as is.
 4. A student in multiple groups can only be claimed by one (the team with earliest occurrence wins).

Input:

1. List of names in queue order
2. Mapping of students to project teams

Output:

Reorganized list with team names and/or students.

Example:

`Input: Teams = { "T1": ["Bob", "Carol", "Dave"], "T2": ["Alice", "Eve"], "T3": ["Frank", "Grace"], "T4": ["Heidi", "Ivan", "Judy", "Eve"] } Queue = ["Alice", "Bob", "Ivan", "Frank"]

Output: ["Alice", "Bob", "Ivan", "Frank"]`

Technical Round - 1: 1 hr 30 mins

This round was primarily focused on Data Structures & Algorithms, Projects and Resume based questions.

The interviewer started with a short intro about himself. Then I gave my intro and I had mentioned my passion for "Astrophysics". The interviewer seemed interested in Astrophysics too. So he asked questions from that. He asked about the recent trends in the field of space for which I mentioned about the different countries of the world trying to prove that America hasn't reached space yet. (Regarding the landing on the moon)

After this, the interviewer went to the DSA part of the interview. The DSA question asked was:

Given an array of `intervals` where `intervals[i]` = any integer, merge all overlapping intervals, and return `_an array of the non-overlapping intervals in the form of {start,end}` that cover all the intervals in the input.

Example:

`intervals = [3,6,2,5,8,1,9,11]`

`output = [{1,3},{5,6},{8,9},{11}]`

My approach to the problem: I proposed an approach of sorting the array and then checking whether there exists an overlap and in case of that add it to the existent output variable.

The approach had a time complexity of $O(n \log n)$. The interviewer helped me with an approach of using a stack. However, I pointed out an edge case with a time complexity of $O(n^2)$ in that and so he proceeded with questions from my resume. It was very much shocking that Appian had only one DSA question for the technical round.

After the DSA questions, the questions were based on my intern experience at Amazon. I was asked about the task I did in Amazon and also how I performed in the team and about my experience at Amazon. After this, the interviewer moved to the tech stack used in Amazon and how I made use of Artificial Intelligence in my intern days.

Project based Questions:

I was asked which was the project in the resume I had worked on and is considered my personal favorite. I chose my Railway DBMS project. I explained what inspired me to do it and the things I tried to do in the project. After which I was asked about the ER structure of the project and the tech stack used. Also the interviewer suggested few more things I could add on to the existing project.

Finally he asked for any questions to him and I asked few questions about work-life balance and career growth at Appian.

HR Round - 1: 15 minutes

The questions were very general

1. What do you know about Appian?
2. What is the meaning of your name?
3. What is your thought about Artificial Intelligence?
4. What AI tools have you used?
5. Regarding school and college CGPA and rankings?
6. What will you choose : Appian or Amazon?

HR Round - 2: 15 minutes

This round was conducted via online mode at CUIC. Started with an introduction.

Questions asked:

1. What was implemented in the Railway DBMS project?
2. How was the large amount of data was stored for the railway project?
3. Amazon or Appian - Choice?

General Tips:

1. Be consistent and stay positive.
2. Be clear in DSA concepts and other core concepts.
3. Practice DSA questions in Leetcode and HackerRank.
4. Have a good resume with clear understanding of all the terms you have put into it.
5. The way you present your approach matters -> Start with the brute force and then optimise the solution and accept feedbacks from the interviewer.

Finally, don't feel disheartened if you get rejected by a company. You still got lot options coming. Put your 100% effort and stay consistent. Your effort would guide you to your company. My first rejection was at Appian and now I am placed at Appian.

Aashin A P (2022506072)

Ex-Amazon SDE Intern, Placed at Appian.

MIT IT 2026

Reach out @ [<https://www.linkedin.com/in/aashin-a-p-21jan2005/>](LinkedIn | Aashin-A-P)

Gmail : apaashin@gmail.com